

Beholding the Majesty of God

Exploring His Divine Attributes

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The Supreme Pursuit of the Heart

*“Let not the wise man boast in his wisdom...
But let the one who boasts boast in this: that he understands and knows me.”
— Jeremiah 9:23-24 (NET)*

*“What comes into our minds when we think about God is the most important thing
about us.” — A.W. Tozer*

*“In the quiet sanctuary of the human heart, few pursuits are more vital than the
earnest contemplation of who God truly is. The more we know about God, the more we
will love Him, trust Him, and obey Him. Understanding His character is the foundation
for a victorious Christian life.” — Dr. Bill Bright*

*“God has revealed His character to us in His Word so that we might know Him
personally and walk with Him intimately. When we understand who God is—His love,
His holiness, His power, His faithfulness—we are transformed. I am convinced that the
greatest need of the church today is for believers to have a fresh vision of the greatness
and glory of God. When we see God as He really is, our problems shrink and our faith
grows.” — Dr. Bill Bright*

This book is an invitation to that fresh vision. Across the following chapters, we will explore twenty key attributes of God, grouped into four foundational categories. These are not distant theological concepts, but living realities that shape how we pray, how we endure trials, how we love others, and how we face each new day.

Attributes of Self-Existence

- God Is Self-Existent
- God Is Eternal
- God Is Infinite
- God Is Transcendent
- God Is Spirit

These attributes reveal the independent, self-sufficient nature of God. He depends on nothing outside Himself. He is the eternal Source from whom all things flow.

Attributes of Sovereignty

- God Is Sovereign
- God Is All-Powerful (Omnipotent)
- God Is All-Knowing (Omniscient)
- God Is Present Everywhere (Omnipresent)
- God Is Unchanging (Immutable)

Here we behold God's supreme rule over all creation. His power, knowledge, and presence are exercised with perfect authority and unwavering faithfulness.

Attributes of Holiness

- God Is Holy
- God Is Righteous
- God Is Just
- God Is Faithful
- God Is Absolute Truth

These attributes display the moral perfection and integrity of God. His holiness is the radiant purity from which justice, righteousness, and truth flow without flaw.

Attributes of Love

- God Is Love
- God Is Merciful
- God Is Gracious
- God Is Good
- God Is Wise

In this final section, we marvel at God's benevolent heart. His love is not abstract but actively expressed through mercy, grace, goodness, and perfect wisdom.

"Once you become aware that the main business that you are here for is to know God, most of life's problems fall into place of their own accord." — J.I. Packer

"Plunge yourself in the Godhead's deepest sea... I know nothing which can so comfort the soul... as a devout musing upon the subject of the Godhead." — Charles Spurgeon

It is our prayer that as you journey through these pages, the Holy Spirit will open your eyes to behold the Lord in fresh and transformative ways. May your knowledge of God move from the mind to the heart, producing deeper worship, stronger faith, greater obedience, and abiding peace.

For our God is worthy — infinitely worthy — of our highest thoughts, our deepest love, and our most wholehearted devotion.

Attributes of Self-Existence

At the very foundation of all that we can know about God lies a profound and awe-inspiring reality: God is self-existent.

This category of attributes reveals the eternal, independent, and utterly unique nature of our Creator. While everything in creation depends on something else for its existence, God depends on nothing and no one outside Himself. He simply is.

These five attributes — Self-Existent, Eternal, Infinite, Transcendent, and Spirit — form the bedrock upon which all other truths about God rest. They declare that God is the uncaused Cause, the eternal Source, and the self-sufficient One from whom all life and reality flow.

God Is Self-Existent

He depends on nothing for His being; He is the great “I AM.”

1. The Revelation of the Divine Name (Exodus 3:13–15)

When Moses asked for God’s name to tell the Israelites, God replied, “I AM WHO I AM” (NET). He instructed Moses to say, “I AM has sent me to you.” This sacred name (Yahweh) reveals God as the self-existent One whose being is eternal and independent — the One who simply is.

2. God Needs Nothing (Acts 17:24–25)

In his address to the Athenians, Paul declared, “The God who made the world and everything in it, being Lord of heaven and earth, does not live in temples made by human hands. Neither is he served by human hands, as though he needed anything, since he himself gives to all mankind life and breath and everything” (NET). This powerfully affirms that God is completely self-sufficient and the Source of all existence.

3. Life in Himself (John 5:26)

Jesus said, “For just as the Father has life in himself, so he has granted the Son to have life in himself” (NET). This reveals that the Father possesses life inherently and independently. Unlike created beings who derive their life from another, God’s life is self-contained and eternal within the Trinity.

4. The Eternal God Before Creation (Psalm 90:2)

“Even before the mountains came into existence, or you brought the world into being, you were the eternal God” (NET). This contrasts the temporary nature of creation with God’s self-existent eternity — He existed fully and perfectly before anything else was made.

5. The Sustainer of All Things (Colossians 1:17; Hebrews 1:3)

“He himself is before all things and all things are held together by him” (Colossians 1:17, NET). The author of Hebrews adds that Christ “sustains all things by his powerful word” (NET). God not only creates but continuously upholds all existence by His own power, while remaining completely independent of it.

Because God is self-existent, I can rest securely in Him, knowing He is my Creator and Sustainer.

God Is Eternal

He exists outside the boundaries of time with no beginning and no end.

1. Before Creation (Psalm 90:2)

“Even before the mountains came into existence, or you brought the world into being, you were the eternal God” (NET). Moses contrasts the fleeting nature of creation with God’s timeless existence, showing that He was fully God long before time itself began.

2. The Alpha and Omega (Revelation 1:8; Revelation 21:6; 22:13)

The Lord declares, “I am the Alpha and the Omega—the one who is, who was, and who is still to come—the all-powerful one” (NET). This title, repeated throughout Revelation, reveals God as the eternal One who encompasses all of history from beginning to end, existing outside its flow while sovereignly ruling it.

3. The High and Lofty One Who Inhabits Eternity (Isaiah 57:15)

“For this is what the high and lofty one says, the one who dwells forever, whose name is holy: ‘I dwell in a high and holy place...’” (NET). God describes Himself as the One who inhabits eternity, emphasizing His transcendence over time and His ability to dwell with the humble and contrite.

4. Christ’s Eternal Preexistence (John 8:58; John 17:5)

Jesus boldly declared to the religious leaders, “I tell you the solemn truth, before Abraham came into existence, I am!” (John 8:58, NET). In His high priestly prayer, He prayed, “And now, Father, glorify me with your own glory that I had with you before the world existed” (NET). These statements affirm the eternal existence of the Son alongside the Father.

5. From Everlasting to Everlasting (Psalm 103:17; Micah 5:2) “But the LORD’s loyal love is forever and ever for those who fear him” (Psalm 103:17, NET). Micah prophesies of the coming Messiah: “But you, Bethlehem Ephrathah... from you will come a ruler for me—one whose origins are from the distant past, from the days of eternity” (NET). These passages affirm that God’s reign, love, and purposes stretch from everlasting to everlasting.

Because God is eternal, I can face each day with patient hope, knowing my labors in His kingdom hold lasting value beyond this fleeting life.

God Is Infinite

He is without any limits in His being, power, knowledge, mercy, love, and presence.

1. The Unfathomable Nature of God (Job 11:7–9)

Zophar asks, “Can you discover the essence of God? Can you find out the perfection of the Almighty? It is higher than the heavens — what can you do? It is deeper than Sheol — what can you know? Its measure is longer than the earth, and broader than the sea” (NET). This highlights that God’s being and ways transcend all human measurement or comprehension.

2. No Limit to His Understanding (Psalm 147:5; Isaiah 40:28)

“Our Lord is great and has awesome power; there is no limit to his wisdom” (Psalm 147:5, NET). Isaiah adds, “The everlasting God, the LORD, the Creator of the ends of the earth does not get tired or weary; there is no limit to his understanding” (NET). God’s knowledge and wisdom are infinite, never exhausted or diminished.

3. The Boundless Love of Christ (Ephesians 3:18–19)

Paul prays that believers may “comprehend with all the saints what is the breadth and length and height and depth, and thus to know the love of Christ that surpasses knowledge” (NET). God’s love is so vast that it exceeds human understanding, stretching infinitely in every direction.

4. Infinite Power and Mercy (Psalm 103:11–12; Isaiah 55:8–9)

“As the sky is higher than the earth, so his loyal love is higher than the heavens for those who fear him. As far as the eastern horizon is from the west, so he removes the guilt of our rebellious actions from us” (Psalm 103:11–12, NET). God’s mercy and power operate on an infinite scale, far beyond human ways or limitations.

5. Unsearchable Judgments and Ways (Romans 11:33–34)

“Oh, the depth of the riches and wisdom and knowledge of God! How unsearchable are his judgments and how unfathomable are his ways!” (NET). Paul’s doxology celebrates the infinite depth of God’s wisdom, knowledge, and sovereign purposes that no finite mind can fully grasp.

Because God is infinite, I can approach every limitation in my life with confident expectation, drawing from His boundless resources.

God Is Transcendent

He exists high above and beyond all creation, distinct from it while sustaining it.

1. God’s Ways Higher Than Ours (Isaiah 55:8–9)

“Indeed, my plans are not like your plans, and my thoughts are not like your thoughts,” says the LORD. “As the sky is higher than the earth, so are my ways higher than your ways and my thoughts than your thoughts” (NET). This declaration reveals God’s thoughts and purposes operating on an infinitely higher plane than human understanding.

2. Heaven Cannot Contain Him (1 Kings 8:27; 2 Chronicles 6:18)

At the dedication of the temple, Solomon prayed, “But will God indeed live on the earth? Look, if the sky and the highest heaven cannot contain you, how much less this temple I have built!” (NET). Even the vast heavens are insufficient to hold the transcendent God, underscoring His distinction from all created things.

3. The Vision of the Exalted Throne (Isaiah 6:1)

“In the year of King Uzziah’s death, I saw the Lord seated on a high, elevated throne. The hem of his robe filled the temple” (NET). Isaiah’s awe-inspiring vision portrays God as high and lifted up, majestic and far above all earthly powers and concerns.

4. Creator Distinct from Creation (Isaiah 40:22–26; Acts 17:24–25)

God is described as the One who “sits enthroned above the circle of the earth” and stretches out the heavens like a curtain (Isaiah 40:22, NET). Paul affirms in Athens that “the God who made the world and everything in it... does not live in temples made by human hands” (Acts 17:24, NET). He is the Creator who stands apart from and above His creation.

5. Sustaining All Things from Above (Colossians 1:17; Hebrews 1:3)

“He himself is before all things and all things are held together by him” (Colossians 1:17, NET). The author of Hebrews adds that the Son “sustains all things by his powerful word” (NET). God transcends creation yet actively upholds every part of it by His sovereign power.

Because God is transcendent, I can trust His higher ways when my understanding fails, submitting my plans to His perfect wisdom.

God Is Spirit

He is purely immaterial, invisible, and unbound by physical limitations.

1. Jesus’ Teaching to the Samaritan Woman (John 4:23–24)

Jesus declared, “But a time is coming — and now is here — when the true worshipers will worship the Father in spirit and truth, for the Father seeks such people to be his worshipers. God is spirit, and the people who worship him must worship in spirit and truth” (NET). This foundational statement reveals God’s immaterial nature and calls for worship that matches His spiritual essence, not limited to physical places or forms.

2. The Invisible God (1 Timothy 1:17; Colossians 1:15)

Paul praises “the King eternal, immortal, invisible, the only God” (1 Timothy 1:17, NET). He also describes Christ as “the image of the invisible God” (Colossians 1:15, NET). These declarations affirm that God’s essential being is invisible and spiritual, not composed of physical matter that can be seen or contained.

3. No Physical Form at Sinai (Deuteronomy 4:12, 15–16)

Moses reminded Israel, “The LORD spoke to you from the middle of the fire; you heard speech but you saw no form — only a voice... Be very careful, for you saw no form on the day the LORD spoke to you at Horeb” (NET). This warns against idolatry because God has no physical form to represent; He is Spirit, distinct from all created things.

4. God Does Not Dwell in Man-Made Temples (Acts 17:24–25; 1 Kings 8:27)

Paul proclaimed, “The God who made the world and everything in it, being Lord of heaven and earth, does not live in temples made by human hands” (NET). This echoes Solomon’s earlier acknowledgment that even heaven cannot contain God. His spiritual nature means He cannot be localized or confined by physical structures.

5. The Lord Is the Spirit (2 Corinthians 3:17–18)

“Now the Lord is the Spirit, and where the Spirit of the Lord is present, there is freedom” (NET). This reveals the dynamic, life-giving presence of God as Spirit, transforming believers from glory to glory as they behold Him — a reality unbound by physical limitations.

Because God is Spirit, I can worship Him sincerely in every moment, free from dependence on external forms or places.

These attributes of self-existence reveal the majestic otherness of God. He is not a larger version of us, nor is He dependent on the universe He created. He is the Fountainhead of all existence, complete in Himself within the perfect fellowship of the Trinity.

To meditate on God’s self-existence is to be humbled by our total dependence and comforted by His gracious invitation to know and walk with Him. In a world that constantly changes and fails us, we find security in the God who has always been fully sufficient and who generously sustains every breath we take.

Attributes of Sovereignty

At the heart of God's interaction with creation lies a majestic and comforting reality: God is sovereign.

This category of attributes reveals His supreme rule and active authority over all things. While human rulers rise and fall, and earthly powers are limited and temporary, God reigns unchallenged as the King of kings. He holds absolute power, perfect knowledge, constant presence, and unchanging faithfulness.

These five attributes — Sovereign, All-Powerful, All-Knowing, Present Everywhere, and Unchanging — declare that nothing is outside His wise and purposeful governance. He works all things according to the counsel of His will for His glory and the ultimate good of His people.

God Is Sovereign

He exercises absolute rule over all creation.

1. Creation of the Universe (Genesis 1:1–31; Psalm 33:6–9)

God spoke, and the heavens, earth, and all living things came into existence by the word of His power. He alone determined the boundaries of the seas, the courses of the stars, and the intricate design of every creature. This foundational act reveals His unchallenged authority as the sovereign Creator who rules over all He has made.

2. Joseph's Life and the Preservation of Israel (Genesis 37–50)

Joseph's brothers intended evil when they sold him into slavery, yet God sovereignly orchestrated every step — from the pit to Potiphar's house, prison, and ultimately the throne of Egypt — to save many lives. As Joseph later declared, "You intended to harm me, but God intended it for good to accomplish what is now being done, the saving of many lives" (Genesis 50:20, NET). This story powerfully shows how God rules over human actions and evil intentions to fulfill His redemptive purposes.

3. The Exodus and Pharaoh's Hardened Heart (Exodus 1–15)

Despite Pharaoh's fierce resistance and repeated defiance, God sovereignly raised him up and hardened his heart to display His power and glory (Exodus 9:16). Through ten plagues and the parting of the Red Sea, the Lord demonstrated that He alone is King over kings and Lord over nature, history, and the hearts of rulers.

4. Nebuchadnezzar's Humbling (Daniel 4)

The proud Babylonian king learned through humiliating judgment that "the Most High is sovereign over all kingdoms on earth and gives them to anyone he wishes" (Daniel 4:17, 25, 32). After being driven to live like an animal, Nebuchadnezzar acknowledged, "He does as he pleases with the powers of heaven and the peoples of the earth. No one can hold back his hand or say to him: 'What have you done?'" (Daniel 4:35, NET). This dramatic account underscores God's absolute rule even over the greatest empires.

5. The Cross of Christ (Acts 2:23–24; 4:27–28)

The crucifixion — the greatest evil in history — was carried out according to "God's deliberate plan and foreknowledge" (Acts 2:23). Wicked men and demonic forces acted freely, yet every detail fulfilled the sovereign will of God to accomplish the redemption of His people. This supreme example shows how God's sovereignty and human responsibility beautifully coexist, with the cross standing as the ultimate display of His wise rule.

Because God is sovereign, I can surrender my anxieties and plans to Him, resting in His wise rule over every detail of my life.

God Is All-Powerful (Omnipotent)

Nothing is too difficult for Him.

- 1. Creation of the Heavens and Earth (Genesis 1:1–31; Psalm 33:6–9; Isaiah 40:26)** By His word alone, God created the entire universe — light, sky, land, seas, stars, and every living creature. He spoke, and it was. This supreme display of power shows that nothing is too difficult for Him; the God who formed all things from nothing sustains everything by the word of His power.
- 2. The Birth of Isaac to Abraham and Sarah (Genesis 18:9–14; 21:1–7)** When Abraham and Sarah were far beyond child-bearing age, God promised them a son. Sarah laughed in disbelief, but the Lord asked, “Is anything too difficult for the LORD?” (Genesis 18:14, NET). Isaac’s miraculous birth proves that God’s power is not limited by human impossibility or natural laws.
- 3. The Parting of the Red Sea (Exodus 14:1–31)**
Trapped between Pharaoh’s army and the sea, Israel appeared doomed. Yet God commanded Moses to stretch out his staff, and the Lord drove back the waters with a strong east wind, creating dry ground for His people to cross. He then closed the waters over their enemies. This dramatic deliverance reveals God’s absolute authority over nature and history.
- 4. The Miracles and Resurrection of Jesus (John 11:38–44; Luke 8:49–56; Matthew 14:13–21; 28:1–10)**
Jesus, the exact representation of the Father’s power, raised Lazarus after four days in the tomb, calmed storms, multiplied loaves and fish, and healed the incurable. His own resurrection from the dead stands as the ultimate testimony that nothing — not even death itself — is too difficult for God.
- 5. The Restoration of Israel from Exile (Jeremiah 32:17, 27; Ezekiel 37:1–14)** Looking at a seemingly hopeless situation, Jeremiah prayed, “Ah, Lord GOD! It is you who have made the heavens and the earth by your great power and by your outstretched arm! Nothing is too hard for you” (Jeremiah 32:17, NET). God later fulfilled His promise by bringing His people back from Babylon and, in the vision of dry bones, showed He can bring life even to what appears utterly dead.

Because God is all-powerful, I can bring every impossibility to Him in prayer, trusting His strength to accomplish what I cannot.

God Is All-Knowing (Omniscient)

He knows all things perfectly.

- 1. The Intimate Knowledge of David (Psalm 139:1–6, 13–16)**
David marvels that the Lord has searched him and knows him completely — when he sits, rises, thinks, or speaks, even before a word is on his tongue. God knit him together in his mother’s womb and ordained all his days before one came to be. This psalm reveals God’s perfect knowledge of every individual’s inner life and entire existence.
- 2. Jesus Knowing Nathanael (John 1:47–49)**
Before Philip brought Nathanael to Jesus, the Lord declared, “Here is a true Israelite, in whom there is nothing false!” When Nathanael asked how He knew him, Jesus replied, “I saw you while you were still under the fig tree before Philip called you.” This encounter shows Christ’s divine ability to know a person’s character and private moments perfectly.

3. **God's Foreknowledge of Israel's Future (Isaiah 44:28–45:4)** Approximately 150 years before Cyrus was born, God named him specifically and declared he would free Israel from Babylonian exile and rebuild the temple. The Lord said, "I am the LORD... who says of Cyrus, 'He is my shepherd, and he will carry out all my purpose'" (Isaiah 44:28, NET). This astonishing prophecy illustrates God's perfect knowledge of future events and people long before they occur.
4. **Jesus Knowing Peter's Denial and Restoration (Luke 22:31–34, 61–62; John 21:15–19)** Jesus knew in advance that Peter would deny Him three times before the rooster crowed, yet He also knew Peter's heart and prayed for his restoration. After the resurrection, Jesus gently restored Peter, demonstrating that God's knowledge includes both our failures and His redemptive plans for our lives.
5. **Nothing Hidden from God (Hebrews 4:13; 1 Samuel 16:7)**

"And no creature is hidden from God, but all are naked and exposed to the eyes of him to whom we must give account" (Hebrews 4:13, NET). God looks at the heart rather than outward appearance, as seen when He chose David over his brothers. This truth assures us that God perfectly knows every motive, secret, and circumstance in our lives.

Because God is all-knowing, I can live with complete honesty before Him, finding peace in being fully understood and loved.

God Is Present Everywhere (Omnipresent)

He is fully present in every place at all times.

1. **David's Awe in Psalm 139 (Psalm 139:7–12)**

David declares, "Where can I go to escape your presence? Where can I flee to escape from your sight?" (Psalm 139:7, NET). He explores every extreme — ascending to heaven, descending to Sheol, traveling to the far side of the sea, or hiding in darkness — and finds that God is there, guiding and holding him with His hand. This intimate psalm reveals God's complete and personal presence everywhere.
2. **God Fills Heaven and Earth (Jeremiah 23:23–24)**

The Lord asks, "Am I only a God who is near, and not a God who is far away?... Do I not fill heaven and earth?" (NET). This declaration confronts any attempt to hide from God or limit Him to one location, affirming that He is intimately near yet sovereignly transcendent over all creation.
3. **Solomon's Prayer of Dedication (1 Kings 8:27; 2 Chronicles 6:18)** Even as Solomon built the magnificent temple, he acknowledged, "But will God indeed live on the earth? Look, if the sky and the highest heaven cannot contain you, how much less this temple I have built!" (NET). This highlights that no structure or place can confine the God who is present everywhere.
4. **Paul's Proclamation in Athens (Acts 17:27–28)**

Paul told the Athenians that God is not far from any one of us, "for in him we live and move about and exist" (NET). This truth underscores that God's presence sustains every person and every moment, whether recognized or not.
5. **Jesus' Promise to His Disciples (Matthew 28:19–20)**

After His resurrection, Jesus commanded His followers to make disciples of all nations and assured them, "And remember, I am with you always, to the end of the age" (NET). Through the Holy Spirit, the omnipresent Christ remains fully with every believer, wherever they may be.

Because God is present everywhere, I can experience His nearness in every place and situation, never truly alone.

God Is Unchanging (Immutable)

His character and purposes remain constant forever.

1. God's Declaration to Israel (Malachi 3:6)

"For I, the LORD, do not change; therefore you, O children of Jacob, are not consumed" (NET). In the midst of Israel's unfaithfulness, God affirms that His covenant loyalty remains steadfast. His unchanging nature is the reason His people are preserved rather than destroyed.

2. The Father of Lights (James 1:17)

"Every good gift and every perfect gift is from above, coming down from the Father of lights with whom there is no variation or shadow due to change" (NET). James contrasts the shifting circumstances of life with the unwavering goodness of God, who never wavers in His generosity or character.

3. Jesus Christ, the Same Forever (Hebrews 13:8)

"Jesus Christ is the same yesterday and today and forever" (NET). This truth anchors the believer's hope, assuring us that the compassion, power, and faithfulness displayed by Christ during His earthly ministry remain fully active today and for all eternity.

4. God's Unchanging Word and Promise (Numbers 23:19; Isaiah 40:8)

Balaam declared, "God is not a man, that he should lie, or a son of man, that he should change his mind. Has he said, and will he not do it? Or has he spoken, and will he not fulfill it?" (NET). Similarly, Isaiah proclaims, "The grass withers, the flower fades, but the word of our God will stand forever" (NET). These verses highlight that God's purposes and declarations are eternally reliable.

5. The Enduring Creator (Psalm 102:25–27; Hebrews 1:10–12)

The psalmist contrasts the temporary nature of creation — "They will perish, but you remain; they will all wear out like a garment" — with God's eternal sameness: "You are the same, and your years have no end" (NET). Even as the universe changes and decays, God remains perfectly constant.

Because God is unchanging, I can depend on His character and promises even when circumstances shift around me.

These attributes together assure us that the universe is not governed by chance, fate, or human ambition, but by the steady hand of a holy, wise, and loving King. In a world that often feels chaotic and out of control, God's sovereignty offers profound peace and calls us to humble, joyful submission.

To know that the same God who rules the stars also watches over our lives is one of the greatest comforts of the Christian faith.

Attributes of Holiness

At the very center of God's moral perfection shines the radiant attribute of holiness.

This category reveals the flawless integrity and ethical purity of our God. While His sovereignty displays His supreme rule and His love reveals His benevolent heart, His holiness shows us that He is utterly separate from all sin and perfectly righteous in every way.

These five attributes — Holy, Righteous, Just, Faithful, and Absolute Truth — form the moral foundation of His character. They declare that God is not only great in power, but perfectly good in all His ways. In a world filled with moral confusion and compromise, God's holiness stands as the unchanging standard of what is right, true, and pure.

God Is Holy

He is perfectly pure and set apart from all sin.

1. Isaiah's Vision of the Throne (Isaiah 6:1-7)

In the year King Uzziah died, the prophet Isaiah saw the Lord seated on a high and lofty throne. Seraphim cried out, "Holy, holy, holy is the LORD of Heaven's Armies! The whole earth is full of his glory!" (NET). Overwhelmed by God's holiness, Isaiah confessed his own uncleanness, and a seraph touched his lips with a live coal from the altar, cleansing him. This vision reveals God's perfect purity that exposes sin and provides cleansing.

2. The Burning Bush and Holy Ground (Exodus 3:1-6)

While tending sheep, Moses encountered the angel of the LORD in a bush that burned but was not consumed. God said, "Do not approach any closer! Take your sandals off your feet, for the place where you are standing is holy ground" (NET). This encounter underscores that God's presence makes ordinary places sacred and demands reverence because of His perfect holiness.

3. God's Command to His People (Leviticus 19:2; 1 Peter 1:15-16)

The Lord declared to Israel, "You must be holy because I, the LORD your God, am holy" (NET). This command, repeated in the New Testament, shows that God's holiness is not only His own nature but the standard to which He calls His people. It flows from His absolute separation from sin and complete devotion to righteousness.

4. God's Judgment on Profane Worship (Leviticus 10:1-3)

When Nadab and Abihu offered "strange fire" before the Lord, fire came out from the LORD's presence and consumed them. Moses explained, "This is what the LORD has said: 'I will show myself holy among those who are near me, and I will glorify myself before all the people'" (NET). This solemn event illustrates that God's holiness cannot be treated casually and demands pure worship.

5. The Heavenly Worship in Revelation (Revelation 4:8)

The four living creatures around the throne never cease saying, "Holy, holy, holy is the Lord God Almighty, who was and who is and who is still to come!" (NET). This eternal anthem in heaven reveals that God's holiness is central to the worship of all creation, both now and forever.

Because God is holy, I can pursue purity in my thoughts and actions, approaching Him with reverent awe.

God Is Righteous

All His ways and decisions are morally perfect.

1. Abraham's Plea for Sodom (Genesis 18:22–33)

As God prepared to judge the wicked cities of Sodom and Gomorrah, Abraham boldly asked, “Will you really sweep away the righteous with the wicked?... Shall not the Judge of all the earth do right?” (NET). God patiently engaged with Abraham, agreeing to spare the cities for the sake of even ten righteous people. This encounter reveals God's perfect justice: He never punishes the innocent and always acts with flawless moral equity.

2. The Rock Whose Work Is Perfect (Deuteronomy 32:3–4)

Moses declared in his final song, “The Rock — his work is perfect, for all his ways are just. He is a faithful God who does no wrong; he is righteous and upright” (NET). This description of God's character, given to Israel after their wilderness journey, affirms that every act of God — in blessing, discipline, or deliverance — flows from perfect righteousness.

3. God's Righteousness Displayed at the Cross (Romans 3:21–26)

Paul explains that God presented Christ as a sacrifice of atonement “to demonstrate God's righteousness, because in his forbearance he had left the sins committed beforehand unpunished — he did it to demonstrate his righteousness at the present time, so as to be just and the one who justifies those who have faith in Jesus” (NET). At the cross, God's righteousness and love perfectly converge: He upholds justice by punishing sin while extending mercy to sinners through Christ.

4. The Lord Is Righteous in All His Ways (Psalm 145:17; Psalm 119:137) The psalmist proclaims, “The LORD is righteous in all his ways and faithful in all his activities” (NET). In Psalm 119, he cries, “You are righteous, O LORD, and your judgments are upright” (NET). These declarations, born out of deep meditation on God's Word and works, celebrate the consistent moral perfection seen in His laws, promises, and providential care.

5. The Righteous Judge of All Nations (Psalm 96:10–13; Revelation 19:11) “He comes to judge the earth. He will judge the world with righteousness and the peoples with his truth” (Psalm 96:13, NET). This theme culminates in Revelation, where the returning Christ is called “Faithful and True, and with justice he judges and makes war” (Revelation 19:11, NET). God's final judgments will be perfectly righteous, vindicating the righteous and punishing evil without partiality.

Because God is righteous, I can strive to reflect His moral perfection in my daily conduct and relationships.

God Is Just

He renders perfect fairness in every judgment.

1. The Flood and Noah's Salvation (Genesis 6–9)

As human wickedness reached its peak, “The LORD saw that the wickedness of man was great in the earth, and that every intention of the thoughts of his heart was only evil continually” (Genesis 6:5, NET). God justly brought the flood upon the earth, yet in perfect fairness He preserved Noah and his family because Noah was righteous. This event reveals God's unwavering commitment to judge evil while showing mercy to the faithful.

2. Judgment on Egypt and Deliverance of Israel (Exodus 7–14)

Through ten plagues, God executed precise justice against Pharaoh and the Egyptians for their oppression and idolatry. Each plague targeted a specific Egyptian deity, culminating in the death of the firstborn. Yet God provided the Passover lamb for Israel, so that “when he sees the blood... the LORD will pass over the door” (Exodus 12:13, NET). This displays God’s justice that punishes oppressors while delivering the oppressed.

3. David’s Sin and God’s Judgment (2 Samuel 11–12)

After David committed adultery with Bathsheba and arranged Uriah’s death, the prophet Nathan confronted him. God’s judgment was swift and proportionate: “Now therefore the sword shall never depart from your house” (2 Samuel 12:10, NET). Yet because David repented, God forgave him while still allowing the consequences to unfold. This shows God’s justice is neither lenient nor vindictive but perfectly balanced with mercy.

4. The Cross — The Pinnacle of Justice and Mercy (Romans 3:25–26; Isaiah 53:5–6) At Calvary, God’s justice was fully satisfied as Christ bore the punishment for our sins. “God presented him as a propitiation... to demonstrate God’s righteousness” (Romans 3:25, NET). The cross upholds perfect justice (sin is punished) while extending perfect mercy (sinners are forgiven). No greater display exists of God’s fair and holy judgment.

5. The Final Judgment (Revelation 20:11–15; Matthew 25:31–46)

John describes the great white throne judgment where “the dead were judged according to what they had done as recorded in the books” (Revelation 20:12, NET). Every person receives exactly what is due according to their deeds, with no favoritism. This final accounting confirms that God’s justice will ultimately prevail over all injustice, evil, and hidden sin.

Because God is just, I can act with fairness and integrity, trusting Him to right every wrong in His perfect time.

God Is Faithful

He never fails to keep His promises or covenants.

1. God’s Covenant with Abraham (Genesis 12:1–3; 15:1–21; 21:1–7) God promised Abraham descendants as numerous as the stars and that through his offspring all nations would be blessed. Despite Abraham and Sarah’s advanced age and moments of doubt, God remained faithful. Isaac was born at the exact appointed time, fulfilling the promise and laying the foundation for the covenant people. This shows God’s perfect reliability across generations.

2. God’s Deliverance and Provision for Israel (Deuteronomy 7:9; Exodus 13–16) The Lord declared, “Know therefore that the LORD your God is God, the faithful God who keeps covenant and steadfast love with those who love him and keep his commandments, to a thousand generations” (NET). He proved this by delivering Israel from Egypt, parting the Red Sea, providing manna daily, and guiding them through the wilderness for forty years despite their repeated complaints.

3. God’s Covenant with David (2 Samuel 7:8–16; 1 Kings 8:23–24)

God promised David an enduring throne and kingdom. Even through the failures of David’s descendants and the exile, the Lord preserved the line, ultimately fulfilling it in Jesus Christ, the eternal King from David’s line. Solomon later praised God: “You have kept for your servant David my father what you declared to him” (NET).

4. **Fulfillment of Prophecy in Christ (Luke 1:68–73; 2 Corinthians 1:20)** Zechariah, filled with the Holy Spirit, proclaimed that God had “raised up a horn of salvation for us in the house of his servant David, as he spoke by the mouth of his holy prophets from of old” (NET). Paul affirms, “For all the promises of God find their Yes in him [Christ]” (NET). Every Old Testament promise finds its perfect fulfillment in Jesus.
5. **God’s Faithfulness Despite Human Unfaithfulness (Lamentations 3:22–23; 2 Timothy 2:13)** In the midst of Jerusalem’s destruction, Jeremiah declared, “The steadfast love of the LORD never ceases; his mercies never come to an end; they are new every morning; great is your faithfulness” (NET). Paul echoes this truth: “If we are faithless, he remains faithful — for he cannot deny himself” (NET). This reveals God’s covenant loyalty even when His people fail.

Because God is faithful, I can remain steadfast in my commitments, modeling His reliability in my relationships.

God Is Absolute Truth

He is the source and unchanging standard of all truth.

1. Jesus’ Declaration as the Truth (John 14:6)

Jesus said to Thomas, “I am the way, and the truth, and the life. No one comes to the Father except through me” (NET). In this profound statement, Christ reveals that truth is not merely an abstract concept or set of facts but is embodied perfectly in His own person as the eternal Son of God. He is the ultimate standard by which all other claims must be measured.

2. God Cannot Lie (Titus 1:2; Hebrews 6:17–18)

Paul speaks of “God, who never lies” (Titus 1:2, NET), while Hebrews declares, “It is impossible for God to lie” (Hebrews 6:18, NET). This absolute inability to deceive flows from His holy character. When God makes a promise — whether to Abraham or to believers regarding eternal inheritance — it is utterly reliable because He Himself is the essence of truth.

3. God’s Word Is Truth (John 17:17; Psalm 119:160)

In His high priestly prayer, Jesus prayed, “Sanctify them by the truth; your word is truth” (John 17:17, NET). The psalmist affirms, “The sum of your word is truth, and every one of your righteous rules endures forever” (Psalm 119:160, NET). Scripture, as God’s self-revelation, perfectly reflects His truthful nature and serves as the unchanging standard for all doctrine, ethics, and reality.

4. The Contrast with the Father of Lies (John 8:44)

Jesus exposed Satan’s nature: “He was a murderer from the beginning, and does not stand in the truth, because there is no truth in him. When he lies, he speaks according to his own character, for he is a liar and the father of lies” (NET). This stark contrast highlights that God alone is the source of all truth, while all falsehood originates in rebellion against Him.

5. The Faithful and True God (Deuteronomy 32:4; Revelation 19:11) Moses declared, “The Rock — his work is perfect, for all his ways are just. He is a faithful God who does no wrong; he is righteous and upright” (Deuteronomy 32:4, NET). In Revelation, the returning Christ is called “Faithful and True” (Revelation 19:11, NET). These titles affirm that God’s every action, judgment, and revelation is perfectly aligned with reality and moral perfection.

Because God is absolute truth, I can speak and live with honesty, anchoring my life to His unchanging Word.

These attributes of holiness together paint a breathtaking portrait of a God who is morally flawless. His holiness is not cold or distant — it is the beautiful light that exposes darkness, calls us to purity, and draws us near through the cleansing work of Christ.

To understand God's holiness is to be humbled by His perfection and comforted by His grace. It invites us not only to worship Him, but to reflect His holy character in our daily lives — pursuing integrity, justice, faithfulness, and truth in a world that desperately needs to see them.

Attributes of Love

At the radiant center of God's character shines the glorious reality that God is love.

This category of attributes reveals the benevolent, compassionate, and redemptive heart of our Creator. While His self-existence shows His independence, His sovereignty displays His rule, and His holiness reveals His moral purity, God's love expresses His generous desire for relationship and the highest good of His people.

These five attributes — Love, Merciful, Gracious, Good, and Wise — flow from the very heart of God and invite us into a personal, transforming relationship with Him. They remind us that the almighty, holy God is not distant or indifferent, but actively good toward us in Christ.

God Is Love

His very essence is self-giving, sacrificial love.

1. The Gift of His Only Son (John 3:16)

“For this is the way God loved the world: He gave his one and only Son, so that everyone who believes in him will not perish but have eternal life” (NET). This verse reveals the magnitude of God's love: He gave what was most precious to Him — not for the deserving, but for a rebellious world — so that sinners might receive eternal life through Christ.

2. Christ's Death for Sinners (Romans 5:8)

“But God demonstrates his own love for us, in that while we were still sinners, Christ died for us” (NET). At the very moment when humanity was in open rebellion against Him, God gave His Son to die in our place. This is the ultimate display of self-giving, sacrificial love that seeks the good of the undeserving.

3. Hosea's Marriage as a Living Parable (Hosea 1-3)

God commanded the prophet Hosea to marry an unfaithful wife as a picture of His relationship with Israel. Despite repeated adultery, God instructed Hosea to pursue and redeem her. The Lord declared, “I will betroth you to me forever; I will betroth you to me in righteousness and in justice, in steadfast love and in mercy” (Hosea 2:19, NET). This illustrates God's relentless, covenant-keeping love that pursues and restores even the faithless.

4. The Prodigal Son (Luke 15:11-32)

In Jesus' parable, the father (representing God) watches for his wayward son, runs to meet him while he is still far off, embraces him, restores him fully, and celebrates with joy. This story portrays the eager, compassionate, and lavishly forgiving heart of the Father toward every repentant sinner.

5. The Sending of the Holy Spirit and Adoption

(1 John 4:9-10; Romans 8:15-16) “By this the love of God is revealed in us: that God has sent his one and only Son into the world so that we may live through him. In this is love: not that we have loved God, but that he loved us and sent his Son to be the atoning sacrifice for our sins” (1 John 4:9-10, NET). Through the Spirit, we are adopted as children of God and cry, “Abba, Father,” revealing the intimate, relational depth of His self-giving love.

Because God is love, I can extend compassion and forgiveness freely to others as a reflection of His heart.

God Is Merciful

He withholds the punishment we deserve out of tender compassion.

1. The Passover and Deliverance from Egypt (Exodus 12:1–13)

On the night of judgment, God instructed each Israelite household to sacrifice a lamb and apply its blood to their doorposts. He promised, “When I see the blood, I will pass over you, and no plague will befall you to destroy you” (NET). God withheld the judgment that fell on Egypt, showing tender mercy through the substitute sacrifice that pointed forward to Christ.

2. David’s Confession and Forgiveness (2 Samuel 12:1–13; Psalm 51) After Nathan confronted David for adultery and murder, David repented, saying, “I have sinned against the LORD” (2 Samuel 12:13, NET). Though consequences remained, God mercifully spared David’s life and restored his relationship with Him. Psalm 51 reveals the depth of David’s plea for mercy and God’s compassionate response: “The sacrifices of God are a broken spirit; a broken and contrite heart, O God, you will not despise” (NET).

3. Mercy Shown to Nineveh (Jonah 3:1–10; 4:2)

When the people of Nineveh repented after Jonah’s warning, “God saw their deeds, that they turned from their evil way; and God relented concerning the calamity which He had declared He would bring upon them. And He did not do it” (Jonah 3:10, NET). Jonah himself acknowledged God’s character: “I knew that You are a gracious and merciful God, slow to anger and abundant in lovingkindness, One who relents from doing harm” (Jonah 4:2, NET).

4. The Prodigal Son’s Welcome (Luke 15:11–24)

When the wayward son returned, confessing his sin, the father ran to him, embraced him, clothed him in the best robe, and restored him fully as a son. This parable beautifully pictures the Father’s merciful heart that rejoices to forgive and restore without reproach.

5. Jesus and the Woman Caught in Adultery (John 8:1–11)

The teachers of the law brought a woman caught in adultery before Jesus. While the law demanded stoning, Jesus said, “Neither do I condemn you. Go and from now on sin no more” (NET). In tender mercy, He withheld the punishment she deserved and offered her a new beginning.

Because God is merciful, I can approach Him boldly after failure and extend mercy to those who wrong me.

God Is Gracious

He freely bestows unearned favor and kindness upon the undeserving.

1. Noah Finding Grace (Genesis 6:5–8)

In a time when “the LORD saw that the wickedness of man was great in the earth,” God looked upon Noah and declared, “But Noah found favor [grace] in the eyes of the LORD” (NET). Noah was not perfect, yet God sovereignly chose to save him and his family through the ark, illustrating grace given apart from human merit.

2. God’s Covenant with Israel Despite Rebellion (Exodus 33:12–19; 34:6–7) After the golden calf idolatry, God could have destroyed the nation. Instead, He revealed Himself to Moses: “The LORD, the LORD, a God merciful and gracious, slow to anger, and abounding in steadfast love and faithfulness” (Exodus 34:6, NET). He renewed the covenant and continued to dwell among them, showing unearned kindness to a stiff-necked people.

3. The Calling and Transformation of Saul (Paul) (1 Timothy 1:12–16; Acts 9:1–22) While breathing threats and murder against the church, Saul was met by the risen Christ on the Damascus road. Paul later testified, “I received mercy because I acted ignorantly in unbelief, and the grace of our Lord overflowed for me with the faith and love that are in Christ Jesus” (NET). This demonstrates God’s lavish grace poured out on the chief of sinners.

4. Salvation by Grace Through Faith (Ephesians 2:8–9; Titus 3:4–7)

“For by grace you are saved through faith, and this is not from yourselves, it is the gift of God; it is not from works, so that no one can boast” (NET). God’s grace provides what we could never earn — forgiveness, adoption, and eternal life — through the work of Christ.

5. Jesus and Zacchaeus (Luke 19:1–10)

Zacchaeus, a despised tax collector and notorious sinner, was sought out by Jesus, who invited Himself to his house. Despite public outrage, Jesus declared, “Today salvation has come to this household” (NET). This encounter shows grace actively pursuing and transforming the undeserving.

Because God is gracious, I can rest from striving to earn His favor and serve Him from a heart of thankfulness.

God Is Good

He is the source and definition of all goodness, delighting to bless His creation.

1. Creation and the Declaration of Goodness (Genesis 1:4, 10, 12, 18, 21, 25, 31) At each stage of creation, “God saw that it was good.” Upon completing the heavens, earth, and all living things, “God saw all that he had made — and it was very good!” (NET). This reveals God’s inherent goodness poured out in the beauty, order, and abundance of the world He made for His creatures’ enjoyment and His glory.

2. The Lord Is Good — Taste and See (Psalm 34:8; Psalm 119:68)

The psalmist invites, “Taste and see that the LORD is good! How blessed is the one who takes shelter in him!” (Psalm 34:8, NET). In Psalm 119:68 he declares, “You are good and you do good” (NET). These declarations, born from personal experience amid trials, affirm that God’s character and actions are the definition and source of all goodness.

3. Provision in the Wilderness (Exodus 16:1–15; Nehemiah 9:20–21) Despite Israel’s grumbling after leaving Egypt, God graciously sent manna from heaven each morning and quail in the evening, along with water from the rock. Nehemiah later reflected, “You gave your good Spirit to instruct them and did not withhold your manna from their mouths” (NET). This daily provision illustrates God’s fatherly goodness even toward a complaining people.

4. Jesus’ Teaching on the Heavenly Father (Matthew 7:9–11; James 1:17) Jesus asked, “Is there anyone among you who, if his son asks for bread, will give him a stone?... If you then, who are evil, know how to give good gifts to your children, how much more will your Father in heaven give good gifts to those who ask him!” (NET). James reinforces this: “Every good gift and every perfect gift is from above, coming down from the Father of lights” (NET). God delights to give what is best to His children.

5. The Ultimate Gift of Salvation (Romans 8:28, 32; Psalm 84:11)

“And we know that all things work together for good for those who love God” (Romans 8:28, NET). Paul declares, “Indeed, he who did not spare his own Son, but gave him up for us all — how will he not also, along with him, freely give us all things?” (NET). The psalmist affirms, “The LORD God is a sun and shield; the LORD bestows favor and honor. He does not withhold his goodness from those who live with integrity” (Psalm 84:11, NET).

Because God is good, I can look for His kindness in every day and respond with a grateful heart.

God Is Wise

He orders all things with perfect wisdom for the highest good of those He loves.

1. Creation by Wisdom (Proverbs 3:19–20; Psalm 104:24)

“By wisdom the LORD founded the earth; he established the heavens by understanding” (NET). The psalmist declares, “How manifold are your works, O LORD! In wisdom you have made them all; the earth is full of your creatures” (NET). The intricate design, balance, and beauty of the universe reveal God’s perfect wisdom in every detail of creation.

2. Joseph’s Life Story (Genesis 50:20; Genesis 45:5–8)

What Joseph’s brothers meant for evil when they sold him into slavery, God used for good. Joseph later told them, “As for you, you meant evil against me, but God meant it for good, to bring about the saving of many lives” (NET). Through years of suffering, imprisonment, and elevation to power, God sovereignly orchestrated events to preserve Israel and the line of the Messiah — a profound display of divine wisdom working through human actions.

3. Solomon’s Prayer for Wisdom (1 Kings 3:5–14; 1 Kings 4:29–34) When God offered Solomon anything he desired, the king asked for “an understanding mind to govern your people” (NET). God granted him unparalleled wisdom, so that “the wisdom of Solomon surpassed the wisdom of all the people of the east and all the wisdom of Egypt” (NET). This not only blessed Israel but demonstrated that true wisdom comes from God and is given to those who seek it humbly.

4. The Wisdom of the Cross (1 Corinthians 1:18–25; Ephesians 3:10–11) The crucifixion appeared as foolishness and weakness to the world, yet it was “the wisdom of God” (1 Corinthians 1:21, NET). Through the cross, God accomplished the salvation of sinners in a way that perfectly satisfied justice, displayed mercy, and defeated evil — confounding human wisdom. Paul affirms that God’s plan reveals “the manifold wisdom of God” to heavenly powers.

5. God’s Unsearchable Wisdom (Romans 11:33–36; Job 38–41)

After Job’s trials and questioning, God revealed His majestic wisdom through creation, asking, “Where were you when I laid the foundation of the earth?” (Job 38:4, NET). Paul concludes his reflection on God’s redemptive plan with awe: “Oh, the depth of the riches and wisdom and knowledge of God! How unsearchable are his judgments and how incomprehensible his ways!” (Romans 11:33, NET).

Because God is wise, I can seek His guidance in every decision, trusting His ways lead to what is best.

These attributes of love together paint a beautiful portrait of a God whose heart overflows with kindness, mercy, and redemptive purpose. In a broken world filled with pain and rejection, God’s love offers healing, security, and hope.

To know that the same God who is holy and sovereign is also perfectly loving is one of the greatest comforts of the Christian faith. It calls us not only to receive His love with open hearts, but to reflect it in our relationships — extending mercy, grace, goodness, and wisdom to others as a living testimony of who He is.

Live in the Light of His Majesty

As we come to the close of this journey through the attributes of our great God, let us pause in reverent wonder. We have not merely studied ideas about the Almighty; we have beheld glimpses of His magnificent character — the self-sufficient Source of all existence, the sovereign Ruler of history, the holy and righteous One, and the God whose very nature is love.

A Vision of the Whole

Attributes of Self-Existence have shown us the independent, self-sufficient God who simply is — the uncaused Cause and eternal Fountain from whom all life flows. In Him we find our security and rest.

Attributes of Sovereignty (Power and Authority) have revealed the King who rules over all with perfect wisdom and power. In a chaotic world, we rest in His wise governance and surrender our anxieties to Him.

Attributes of Holiness have displayed the flawless moral purity of our God. His holiness calls us to purity while His righteousness, justice, faithfulness, and truth provide the unshakable standard for our lives.

Attributes of Love have unveiled the benevolent heart of the Father. His love, mercy, grace, goodness, and wisdom invite us into intimate relationship and empower us to reflect His kindness to a hurting world.

Together, these twenty attributes paint a breathtaking portrait of the one true God — majestic in power, perfect in holiness, and overflowing in love. He is not distant or unknowable. He has revealed Himself so that we might know Him, love Him, and walk with Him.

Let this study not end with admiration alone. May it lead to deeper worship, humble obedience, and transformed living. Let the self-existent God free you from self-reliance. Let the sovereign King calm your fears. Let the holy God purify your heart. Let the God who is love fill you with compassion for others.

May the Holy Spirit continue to open your eyes to behold the Lord in fresh and transformative ways. May your knowledge of God move from the mind to the heart, producing deeper worship, stronger faith, greater obedience, and abiding peace.

*For our God is worthy — infinitely worthy — of our highest thoughts, our deepest love,
and our most wholehearted devotion.*

To Him be glory, honor, and praise forever. Amen.